proceedings in the same place I had got so drunk in the night before. The staff kept the bar open very late, and I remember Brett Lee playing his guitar, although we didn't really talk to the Aussies much that night. We were on a different vibe to them – as fantastic as winning that game and the series was for us, it must've been correspondingly tough for them.

And that was basically the last I remember of that night. I've no idea how I got to my room. It's sad, I guess, that the day ended in a blank. It had obviously been a very special day, and when you have those days and they end with you so drunk you can't remember much, it's sad in a lot of ways. This has happened to me quite a lot over the years. Many times I look back on an event or an occasion and I can't remember how it ended, simply because I had just been so hammered.

The 2007 World Cup … Karaoke in St Lawrence Gap

After we'd annihilated the Poms in the Super Eight stage of the 2007 World Cup, I was in the mood for a little celebration. We'd bowled them out for 154, with Andrew Hall leading the charge, taking five wickets for 18 runs; and then openers Graeme Smith and AB de Villiers made the majority of the runs in our innings. I didn't even bat. Still, a night out in Barbados was called for. This *was* Barbados, after all. Where the rum comes from.

The Proteas never hang out as a team much any more. I'll tell you more about that later, but the unfortunate trend had already been well established by then. On this occasion, the players did have a couple of beers in the changing room after the game, but I then decided to join a friend of mine, Brian Mahon, and his son Jonathan. Brian's a fairly wealthy chap who owns an apartment in the exclusive Sandy Lane Resort in St James, Barbados. Anyway, Brian looked a little knackered – an afternoon of beer and Barbadian sun can do that to a man – and he ended up having a little nap at the dinner table. I could only look at him and laugh, knowing that I'd done the same on a couple of occasions.

Brian had arranged a driver with a Bentley for the evening, so after dropping him off at home, Jonathan and I decided to hit the bars. Two good-looking guys and a chauffeur-driven droptop Bentley – it would've been criminal not to. There's this little area in Barbados called the St Lawrence Gap, which has lots of bars and clubs. After cruising up and down the main road in the Bent – obviously with the top down – staring at the beautiful women, we got the driver to drop us off and we went for a stroll.